

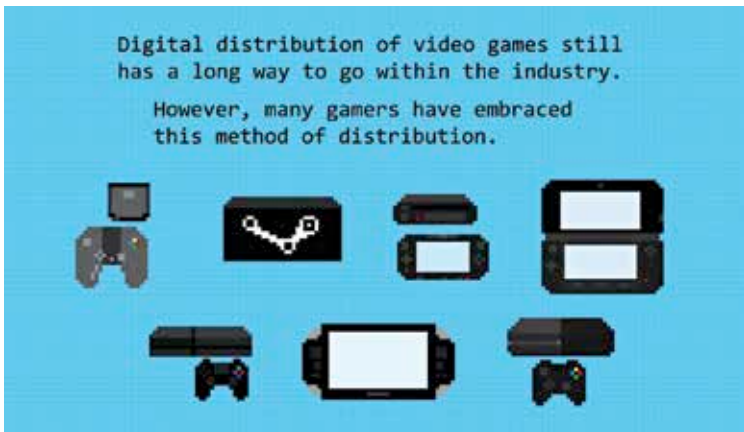
to keep the console software from intrusion. But the problem with CDs is that they are not forever. You lose CDs, you can break them. Also, not every indie developer who built a game on his home computer has the capital to produce CDs and ship them worldwide. The Internet solved this problem.

## The Future is Here

Now there are online services like PlayStation Network and Xbox Live which let you purchase your games online and download them from their servers. This completely eliminates the need for hardware. If you have a steady internet connection and enough empty space on your console, that is all you need to purchase a game for your PlayStation 4 or Xbox One.

The PC master race benefits the most perhaps from this feature because of the Steam gaming community. With the arrival of Steam service, you could now purchase games online and even put up the games you created for anyone to play for free or for a price you find fit. Bill Gates always wanted the gaming community to be free to make changes to the games and his dream has indeed come true. Millions of mods are available, both paid and fan created to make the PC games more fun. The gaming community is like a huge interconnected open source phenomena now. The rise in popularity of these online services might completely eliminate the need for CDs or cartridges – but that is still going to take some time.

So, going back to a point we left abruptly at earlier – what then happened to all those cartridges left from the E.T disaster? They were buried. The Atari



Online distribution seems to be the way forward for a while